

Interference tactics: White, move 26

Interference tactics

White to move

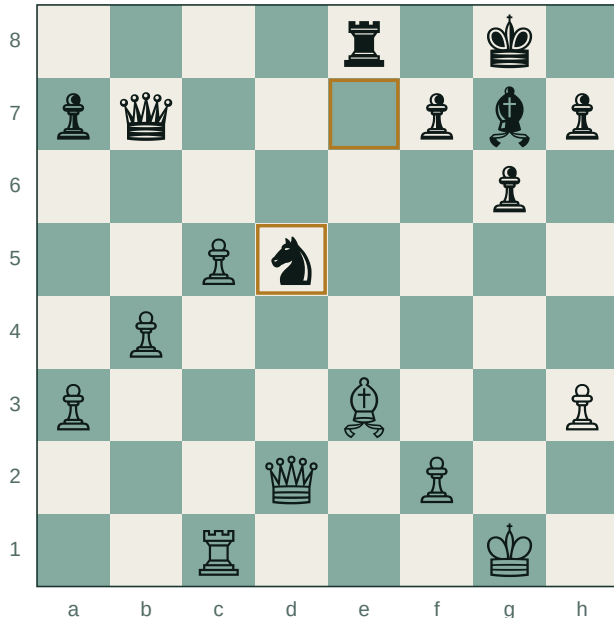
WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on e8 and queen on b7. Check for tactical protection.



Previous move: 25...Nd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26. c6 Qc7 27. Qxd5 Rxe3 28. fxe3

26.c6 The pawn moves from c5 to c6. Recorded reply: **26...Qc7**.

27.Qxd5 The queen captures the knight on d5. Recorded reply: **27...Rxe3**.

28.fxe3 The pawn captures the rook on e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.